MAYA SAYURI MERRILL

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EDUCATION

University of Oregon **Eugene, OR**
Bachelor of Fine Arts in Product Design (GPA: 4.00) June 2024
Minors in Multimedia, Global Service (concentration in Environment) and Science Communication

Harvard University Graduate School of Design **Cambridge, MA**
Design Discovery 2025 Participant in Architecture (3-Week Program) July 2025

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Field States Urban Design Firm **Portland, OR (Hybrid)**
Communications Intern (10hr./week) October 2025 – Present

- Develop and manage social media content strategy for Field States and No Vacancy, shaping clear visual and narrative frameworks to communicate design intent, urban interventions, and community-based work.
- Produce original photo and video content documenting events, activations, and stakeholder interviews, translating spatial experiences and design processes into compelling digital stories.

Electric Aircraft Company **Hillsboro, OR (Remote)**
Contract Illustrator and Designer (10hr./week) August 2025 – Present

- Collaborate directly with the founder to conceptualize an original electric aircraft, using iterative sketching, 3D modeling, and rendering to explore form, function, and feasibility.
- Produce early-stage visualizations and renderings for marketing and stakeholder materials, translating speculative design concepts into clear, compelling representations.

Idea Consultancy **Phnom Penh, Cambodia (Hybrid)**
Branding & Communications Lead (10hr./week) March 2024 – Present

- Designed a cohesive branding system for the ASEAN 2025 Startup Connect Summit, including conference-space graphics, merchandise, and digital assets.
- Developed visual deliverables that unified physical and digital environments, supporting a platform that connects founders across ASEAN member states with mentorship, resources, and tools.

Liger Leadership Academy — Princeton in Asia Fellowship **Phnom Penh, Cambodia**
Digital Arts and Design Instructor (30hr./week) August 2024 – June 2024

- Led project-based learning courses in graphic design and product design—including 3D modeling and prototyping
- Guided students through iterative design processes, emphasizing conceptual development, making, critique, and hands-on experimentation within a cross-cultural learning environment.

United Nations Development Program **Geneva, Switzerland (Remote) / Phnom Penh, Cambodia**
Health and Development Intern; Contract Junior Design Consultant (10hr./week) July 2024 – December 2024

- Supported UNDP staff by researching and editing investment cases, SDG briefs, and road safety reports, contributing to evidence-based policy and planning work.
- Visualized quantitative and qualitative data through clear graphics and layouts, using Adobe Illustrator and InDesign to strengthen analytical reports and presentations.

Hanna Anderson **Portland, OR**
Product Development Intern (20hr./week) June 2024 – August 2024

- Collaborated cross-functionally to design products for nonprofit partner Foster Love, working with partner factories in India to repurpose deadstock fabrics into production-ready designs.
- Supported CAD development and line-adoption meetings, assisting with file editing, design iteration, and coordination across design and manufacturing teams.

CRCC ASIA / ADDReC Design Firm **Tokyo, Japan**
Design & Research Intern (30hr./week) June 2023 – September 2023

- Conducted design research on sustainability, culture, diversity, accessibility, and wellness, informing ADDReC

Design Firm's approach to future architecture and tourism projects in Japan.

- Synthesized and presented findings to multidisciplinary teams, translating social, environmental, and cultural research into actionable design insights.

The Good — E-Commerce Conversion Rate Optimization Agency **Portland, OR (Remote)**
UX Design & Research Intern (20hr./week) June 2023 – September 2023

- Conducted UX research and competitor analyses, developed Figma mockups for marketing materials, and authored a published article on emerging UX design strategies.

Thesis Agency - Emerging Leaders Internship Program **Portland, OR**
Graphic Design Intern (30hr./week) June 2022 – September 2022

- Partnered with the Nike account design team to develop a mock creative advertising campaign rebranding Beyond Toxics, an environmental justice NGO, using Figma, Adobe Illustrator, and Photoshop.

ON-CAMPUS INVOLVEMENT

Holistic Options for Planet Earth Sustainability Conference **Eugene, OR**
Branding Director & Student Panelist (5hr./week) January 2024 – April 2024

- Collaborated with architecture students to establish a cohesive visual identity and outreach strategy, spanning digital media and merchandise.

University of Oregon Marketing and Communications **Eugene, OR**
Graphic Designer, Illustrator, and Video Editor (20hr./week) June 2021 – June 2024

- Developed a cohesive set of promotional graphics, illustrations, and original photo and video content using the Adobe Creative Suite to clearly communicate career and educational resources and strengthen student outreach and engagement.

SKILLS

Design: Adobe Illustrator, InDesign, Photoshop, Figma, hand sketching, rendering, prototyping, and graphic design.
3D Modeling & Fabrication: Rhino, SolidWorks; CAD modeling, rendering, and 3D printing.
Video & Motion: Adobe Premiere Pro, After Effects, and DaVinci Resolve.
Languages: English (Native); French (Advanced—DALF C1, professional experience); Khmer and Japanese (Beginner).

ADDITIONAL INFORMATION

Fellowships & Programs:

- *Circular Design Week (CDW)* — Fellow, 2025: Facilitated CDW in Kyoto, Japan (Dec 18–23), producing promotional video content in partnership with Re:Public (Tokyo).
- *Science and Memory Fellowship* — Fellow, 2023: Media Intern with the U.S. Forest Service in Cordova, Alaska, creating content for the Copper River Delta Shorebird Festival.
- *Sally Smith & Dick Romm Enrichment Fund Award* — Recipient: Awarded $5,000 to support a design-focused internship in Tokyo based on academic excellence and leadership.

Design Awards & Recognitions:

- *International Design Excellence Awards (IDEA)* — Finalist, 2022: Finalist for a product design concept recognized by the Industrial Designers Society of America.
- *Design Nation Conference* — Selected Attendee, 2023: Chosen as 1 of 100 participants for the Business Today–hosted conference in New York City.

International Exhibitions:

- **5Rings:** Exhibited in Eugene, OR (June 2024); Dutch Design Week, Eindhoven, NL (Oct 18–26, 2025); Greener Manufacturing, Cologne, Germany (Nov 12–13, 2025).

Hobbies/Interests: Traveling (31 countries and counting); language learning; long-distance running (2 marathons so far); illustration; music (a cappella, choir, piano, and digital production); blogging!